



MONTHLY UPDATE

Training and skills: monthly update, August 2026

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ANGOLA · BENIN · CAMEROON · COMOROS · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · DR CONGO · EGYPT ·
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RWANDA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · TANZANIA · TUNISIA ·
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Angola

A new technology centre [entered service in August](#), framed by the ministry around protecting citizens' data and training young people. No intake, curriculum, cost or site detail is published, and the data-protection framing is the ministry's rather than a stated function of the centre.

Benin

Two cohorts opened in the month, both small and both institutional. The state information-systems agency [began a certification programme for 25 departmental information-security officers on 3 August](#), and the capital's town hall [opened an artificial-intelligence academy for 60 secondary pupils on 19 August](#), framed on urban problems. Neither publishes a curriculum, a completion standard or a plan for a second cohort.

Cameroon

Training moved as a building rather than as a cohort. Stakeholders [met on 20 August on a public-service digital training campus and its learning platform](#). No site, budget, curriculum or intake is published, so what the base holds is an intention with a meeting behind it.

Comoros

Two pupils of the private école Mouigni Baraka, Anmar Mohamed and Hafsoit Idrisse, [became Comoros's first entrants to the International Olympiad in Artificial Intelligence, competing at the third edition in Astana, Kazakhstan, from 2 to 8 August 2026](#), selected from four shortlisted candidates drawn from several schools. The delegation was led by Chamsoudine Soudjay, secretary-general of the Association comorienne des technologies de l'information et de la communication (ACTIC), and entered through the Olympiad's GAITE (Global AI Talent Empowerment) programme for emerging nations, with the participation funded jointly by ANADEN, its supervising ministry and ACTIC Academy rather than by any domestic training programme. No result is on record, and the competition's own close falls after this window.

Cote d'Ivoire

The civil-service digital-skills programme [closed its thirteenth edition on 29 July](#), training 192 officials from about thirty public bodies over 40 days, against a cumulative claim of more than 37,500 civil servants funded from the ministry's own budget line.

Outside the service, a German-funded accelerator closed a three-month cohort on 4 August, [closing with 51 artificial-intelligence projects across finance, health, law, education and cybersecurity](#). The project count is the only measure published: participant numbers, cost and what becomes of the projects after the demonstration day are not stated, and a project shown at one is not a deployed system.

Djibouti

Against unemployment, the state is [using digital channels to connect graduates with recruiters](#). The account names no platform, no registration count and no placement figure, so what is held is a stated direction rather than a measurable one. It is read here alongside the [spring economic monitor](#), whose school-to-work analysis is the closest thing the base holds to a measure of the problem the initiative is written against.

DR Congo

The employment office launched a [portal and mobile application in July](#) on which jobseekers register skills and employers post needs, intended to build a national skills database. It was externally financed, and no user or placement figure is held.

The digital economy ministry [opened the first of a planned series of five-day training sessions for 580 of its own agents and managers](#) at the INPES in Kinshasa on 24 August 2026. No curriculum, completion target or budget line is published.

The land ministry [closed a roughly month-long course for 50 conservators of property titles on 25 August, drawn from several provinces and run with the national school of administration as part of a capacity-building programme under the land reform](#), setting it alongside archiving operations already running in seven pilot land districts of Kinshasa; no further wave or provincial timetable is stated.

Egypt

The state's university artificial-intelligence programme closed its fourth round on 4 August with 1,090 students and 445 projects, taking the cumulative total since 2022 to 2,710 students ([round account](#)). A tripartite agreement added mentoring and real healthcare datasets to student projects, with no data-governance arrangement stated for the patient-derived data.

Equatorial Guinea

An investigation opened into [where more than 425 million CFA francs allocated to equip the university computer room at Bata went](#). It is a capacity line the base can date and price, and cannot yet say produced anything; no finding, charge or recovery has followed.

Eswatini

At the Macetjeni handover the ICT ministry's principal secretary said [AI, robotics, coding and cybersecurity courses would follow](#) at the innovation hubs.

The hub itself opened on 6 August at Macetjeni in the Lubombo Region, [the second of its kind, backed by the development programme with the communications regulator and the small-enterprise development company and aimed at young people, women and people with disabilities](#). It opens against an internet-usage rate of 58% and youth unemployment of 56%. No intake target, running cost or funding term is published, so what a second hub is expected to change cannot be read from the account.

Ethiopia

The flagship coder-training programme is [now reported as a seven million coders initiative](#), a target raised from the five million the digital transformation council had been working to. The raise is reported rather than gazetted, and no enrolment, completion or certification figure accompanies it.

Gabon

Certification training is [under way for participants at Libreville's American Corner under a digital-skills programme run with United States embassies](#). No cohort size or completion date is published.

More than 130 young people have been [trained in cybersecurity, networks, artificial intelligence and programming since June 2026](#) under a programme with the United States. No curriculum, certification or placement outcome is published.

Ghana

Training capacity was the month's activity. A youth agency [signed for 2,000 vendor-certified microdegree places on 14 July](#) — Ghana taking 2,000 of the 3,000 allocated to the whole continent — fully government-funded, with 600 paid internships and a five-region pilot, and no programme cost disclosed. [A university became the first tertiary institution to embed the national coders programme permanently in its curriculum on 29 July, receiving a further 2,000 laptops the next day.](#)

Kenya

The 117th digital hub was [commissioned in Baringo on 20 July](#) on the ceremony series, against a separate installed-base series of about 350 that the programme's own officials also use.

Certification reached the platform economy from the other direction, in one county and at small scale. A ride-hailing operator and the Mombasa county government [launched a programme to license 400 delivery riders through the national Recognition of Prior Learning framework, the operator committing KES 1.5 million: riders complete 21 days of accredited training at a certified driving school before the transport and safety authority licenses them on demonstrated competency, under a January 2026 memorandum covering compliance, safety, youth employment and platform adoption, and the operator will share trip and demand data with the county for infrastructure planning including the siting of electric-vehicle charging points](#). Four hundred riders is set against a sector a 2025 parliamentary report puts at more than two million, and no data-sharing agreement, retention rule or privacy basis for the trip and demand data accompanies it.

Lesotho

MICSTI reported [digital-literacy training running across all ten districts](#) at the CSIRT launch on 29 July, with no participant numbers published.

Liberia

UNDP also [announced a partnership with the University of Liberia](#) to establish the country's first master's degree in [artificial intelligence](#), with no commitment amount disclosed.

Libya

The Islamic Development Bank Institute [announced on 2 August that it had run an executive programme for Central Bank of Libya officials](#) covering Sukuk issuance, liquidity and portfolio management, treasury operations and settlements, and emerging AI-related security risks. The Libya Observer places the programme at IsDB headquarters in Jeddah from 27 to 30 July 2026. Participant numbers, curriculum and any standard behind the AI component are unstated.

Madagascar

The digital ministry [received 259 applications by 1 August 2026 for ten established civil-service posts](#), split between the capital and the regional directorates. The fields are artificial intelligence, data management, digital innovation, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law, the last covering personal data protection and electronic commerce. Applicants have publicly asked for integrity guarantees on the selection, and no appointment has been announced.

Malawi

An operator's school programme reports [36 schools connected with a further nine scheduled in 2026, laboratories equipped with smart televisions and tablets, 12 local e-learning sites zero-rated, and more than 32,000 learners and over 900 teachers benefiting directly](#). All the figures are the company's own; the [continental partnership behind it is worth US\\$57m and targets 5,000 schools across 13 countries by 2027](#). The same foundation's scholarship arm named its [first 25 beneficiaries on 18 August, drawn from 17 districts and taking eight programmes at the science and technology university, computer systems and cyber security among them](#) — the places announced at the January launch, filled seven months later. No continuation beyond the one cohort is stated.

Mali

The same 22 July an operator [reported 350 young people placed on the labour market](#) from its digital centre.

On 30 July UNESCO and Japan [handed the education ministry FCFA 88,740,927 of equipment for eight teacher-training institutes](#) — 40 laptops, 16 all-in-one computers, 32 tablets, and projectors, whiteboards, printers and backup devices — with no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated.

On 1 August recruitment opened for the first cohort of a [digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people](#) run under a convention with the Association Kabakoo.

Mauritania

The Ministry of Vocational Training [launched a digital-employability project on 23 July](#) financed by France's Fonds Équipe France and implemented by Simplon: 2,150 beneficiaries across six cities, about 2,000 of them young people, with a stated focus on women and people with disabilities. It succeeds a programme closed in 2025.

The university opened the first edition of a summer school on language models for low-resource African languages at Nouadhibou on 25 August, [taking participants from corpus construction and semantic annotation through model adaptation and evaluation to prototypes in translation and conversational assistants](#).

Mauritius

The incumbent operator opened a national cybersecurity and artificial-intelligence awareness programme for secondary students with the education ministry, [starting on 13 August at the Mahatma Gandhi Institute with about 500 Grade 10 to Grade 12 students drawn from all four education zones](#), and free ten-hour AWS training on offer alongside. A [companion account of the same workshop](#) describes its content as online risk and responsible use of new technologies. It is an operator-run programme rather than a curriculum change, and no full-year target, budget or evaluation is stated.

Mozambique

The European Union digital programme's training reached delivery. [Pilot training was delivered and assessments completed under the digital skills curriculum](#). The project page is undated and rolling, so no cohort size, completion rate or date can be placed against it.

Namibia

A private provider [opened an artificial-intelligence academy in Windhoek](#) for Namibian organisations. It is a commercial offering rather than a public programme, which is what the base otherwise holds nothing of here; no intake, curriculum or fee structure is published.

Niger

Skills work travelled rather than sat still. The Niger Digital Day caravan [trained 140 young people at its Tahoua stage on 25 August](#), one leg of a programme its organisers say will run in all eight regions and reach more than 800 young people. Coverage and reach are the organisers' own figures and no completion or follow-up count is published, so the caravan is on record as a plan being executed rather than as a measured outcome.

Nigeria

A [diaspora health-workforce registry is described as newly launched](#), with no launch date, custodian agency, enrolment terms or data-protection basis stated in anything held — a register standing up ahead of its governance.

Rwanda

The digital-ambassador programme that [trained 1,567,034 citizens](#) concluded its financing phase in May 2026 and no successor financing is held.

Where training did continue it went to the top of the system rather than the bottom. The United Nations development programme's quarterly account of 1 August records [artificial-intelligence trust-and-safety training delivered to senior officials, financial and telecommunications actors and the judiciary, funded by Canada](#).

Participant numbers, curriculum and cost are not stated, and the funder's own newsletter is the only account of it held.

Senegal

Two facts about the state's own capacity arrived in the same week and point opposite ways. The national statistics agency [graduated 60 statisticians - 33 statistician-economists and 27 statistician-analysts, drawn from ten African countries - taking its school's cumulative output past 900 since 2011](#), and used the ceremony to press ministries to recruit them into sectoral statistical services: an absorption problem stated rather than measured, since no figure is

published for how many of the 900 work in Senegalese public statistics. Against it, the National Assembly [voted 129-0 to open a commission of inquiry into about 48 billion FCFA committed since 2017 under the student-computer programme, over alleged procurement breaches and 800 defective machines stored unused at the country's largest university](#). The programme has run for nine years and publishes no delivery total, unit cost or student-reach figure, so the inquiry's envelope is the only quantity the record holds about it.

Sierra Leone

MoCTI and three other bodies [launched a digital skills programme for civil servants on 10 July 2026, with 1,000 places in year one and stated targets of 3,000 medium-term and 5,000 long-term across six areas including artificial intelligence and cybersecurity, aimed at gaps outside Freetown](#).

The country held its [first academic exhibition dedicated to Digital Public Goods on 27 July, where 11 student-built solutions were evaluated against the DPG Standard](#). The curriculum behind it, built with UNICEF, the United Nations University and Limkokwing University, has [taught more than 1,100 students and appointed 14 campus champions across four universities](#).

On the skills side, [eighty young people graduated from a nine-month digital-literacy course at Kenema on 8 August, reporting job retention and promotion](#). The outcomes are the graduates' own and no tracer study is held.

Somalia

In the north, the Somaliland administration [launched fixed-asset training for public financial accountability on 4 August](#). No participant total, system or completion date is stated, and the base carries no earlier position for it.

South Africa

The information technology sector education and training authority was [referred for a governance assessment](#).

The pipeline that authority sits in was reviewed on 14 August. A development bank's report with the higher education department, philanthropically funded, finds [the route from school through universities and technical colleges into employment constrained at both ends — young people arriving without the foundational digital skills the workplace needs, and employers unable to fill digital vacancies alongside high unemployment](#). Its finding is that the mismatch is structural and will not correct itself. That is a verdict on the strategy already under review on this ledger rather than a new instrument.

One intervention was announced against that pipeline, at the far end of the country and five months out. A networking vendor's academy and a private group agreed with the Northern Cape education department to take [networking, cyber security and artificial-intelligence courses into 235 schools as extracurricular classes for grades 10 to 12 from February 2027](#), inside a global programme the vendor says has already trained more than 600,000 South Africans. No learner target, cost, funding split, teacher-training provision or certification pathway accompanies it, and the training figure is the vendor's own.

The industry association put up a route of its own, [launching a portal to link employers, ICT jobseekers and graduates and professional development in one platform rather than as a conventional job board, against what it calls the disconnect between people holding ICT skills and the businesses that need them; no listing, placement or funding figure accompanies it](#). At the other end of the pipeline, industry began paying for places itself. Two domestic firms [joined a data-centre operations academy as industry partners and are sponsoring a full candidate cohort for its 2026 intake, the first South African firms to fund a whole cohort, one opening a newly launched Midrand OEM training facility and the other a live operational data centre to supply the practical component of a graduate-to-employment](#)

[pipeline](#), the sponsoring founder framing it as a recruitment expense rather than a training one — which is the clearest statement yet of why the estate's operators are not waiting for the state pipeline above. No cohort size, placement rate or cost per place is published.

South Sudan

Two private training deliverables closed the month. A mobile operator's money arm [graduated 1,225 entrepreneurs from a digital-finance skills programme on 24 August](#), and the same operator [opened an ICT hub at Aweil in Northern Bahr el Ghazal](#). Both are the operator's own programmes and its own figures; no state training line stands beside them on this ledger.

Tanzania

Training in the window is bought rather than built. Zanzibar's public service [signed a three-year memorandum for artificial-intelligence and cybersecurity capacity building](#), and an operator's foundation [expanded its digital skills programme for young people](#). Neither carries a cohort size, curriculum, certification or cost on the record held, so the base can date the commitments and cannot size them.

Tunisia

The family and women's ministry, a national entrepreneurs' organisation and a UN regional commission [opened a training programme for 100 women entrepreneurs in e-commerce and artificial-intelligence applications, alongside a national platform for marketing women's products](#). Both sit under a [declaration on women, youth, digitalisation and African economic integration whose action plan targets training 100,000 women and young people in e-commerce, AI and cross-border digital payments by 2028](#), and a US\$50m fund for inclusive markets by the same date. The training launch's own date is not established in the source.

Uganda

The state ICT institute reports [48,448 people trained in the financial year: 36,332 citizens, 1,932 government officers, 1,207 educators and instructors and 8,977 in immersive and emerging-technology skills](#), with 65 certified trainers produced. The figures are self-reported and unaudited, and [fewer than 4% of those trained were government officers](#).

The IT authority [invited expressions of interest for consultancy services to develop a National Digital Skills and Competence Framework](#). Nothing is yet awarded, and no scope value or delivery date is stated.

An operator's programme published a cohort figure on 31 August. It [graduated 503 young people at the National ICT Innovation Hub from a hybrid course in information and communication technology, digital marketing, e-commerce, cybersecurity and artificial intelligence, taking its cumulative total to 1,191](#). The counts are the operator's own, and no employment outcome, start year or cost per participant is published.

Zambia

Training in the window is a private programme rather than a state one. A ride-hailing company's fellowship [expanded to six African countries and selected its 2026 cohort](#), this country among them. No Zambian intake figure, curriculum or placement outcome is published, and no state training total sits on the ledger for the month.

Zimbabwe

The ICT minister told a small-business meeting on 17 July that a digital skills programme targets 1.5 million people ([meeting account](#)).

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